NORTHSTAR
DIGITAL SERVICES

Work-from-Home Policy

EMPLOYEE • MANAGER • HR

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Prepared as synthetic content for a role-based retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) demonstration. This document is not an actual company policy.

Access classification: EMPLOYEE • MANAGER • HR

1. Purpose and eligibility

Policy owner: HR

Purpose

This policy sets expectations for remote and hybrid work at Northstar Digital Services, a fictional company. It aims to balance flexibility, security, collaboration and service continuity.

Eligibility

Remote-work eligibility depends on role duties, customer commitments, data sensitivity, equipment availability and local employment requirements. A role may be fully on-site, hybrid or remote; eligibility does not guarantee approval for every location or schedule.

Approval

Employees should obtain written approval from their manager and complete any required HR or IT checks before changing their regular work location. Temporary remote work from another country or region requires separate review because tax, employment, security and data rules may differ.

Work hours

Employees are expected to follow agreed working hours, attend scheduled meetings and communicate availability. Flexible hours may be agreed with a manager, provided coverage and applicable rest-period requirements are respected.

Work environment

Employees should maintain a reasonably private, safe workspace and use company-approved devices and connectivity. The company does not expect employees to expose confidential work to household members or public viewers.

No change to core duties

Remote work does not change performance expectations, confidentiality duties, attendance recording or the obligation to follow company policies.

2. Daily operating standards

Policy owner: HR

Availability and communication

Keep calendar status current, respond within team-agreed service windows and tell the manager when connectivity or an emergency prevents work. Use approved collaboration tools for work discussions.

Meetings

Join on time, use an appropriate setting and avoid sharing confidential screens where others can view them. Meeting organizers should make participation accessible to remote and on-site colleagues.

Equipment

Use company-managed laptops and approved peripherals. Report lost, stolen or damaged equipment promptly. Do not lend company devices to family members or install unapproved software.

Network security

Use a trusted, password-protected network and company VPN or secure access service where required. Avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive work unless an approved secure connection is active. Never bypass endpoint security controls.

Physical security

Lock the screen when away, store devices securely and prevent unauthorized people from viewing printed or digital records. Shred or return sensitive printouts through approved processes.

Expenses

Reimbursement for internet, equipment or workspace costs depends on the employee's location and the current expense policy. Obtain pre-approval where required and submit genuine receipts.

Health and safety

Take appropriate breaks, set up a safe workstation and report work-related safety concerns through the designated process. Remote work does not remove the company's or employee's applicable safety obligations.

3. Review, exceptions and troubleshooting

Policy owner: HR

Performance and trust

Managers should assess outcomes, quality, reliability and collaboration rather than relying solely on online presence. Employees should raise blockers early and keep work status accurate.

Confidential information

Do not discuss restricted matters in public places, use personal email for company files or transfer records to unapproved storage. Follow data classification and incident reporting policies.

Temporary changes

A short-term change due to illness, caregiving, travel or a building closure should be discussed with the manager. HR may be needed for accommodation, legal or cross-border considerations.

Ending or changing an arrangement

Remote arrangements may be reviewed when role requirements, performance, security or business coverage changes. The manager should explain the reason and consult HR when required; applicable contracts and laws remain controlling.

FAQ: May I work from a café?

Only if company rules allow it and privacy and secure connectivity can be maintained. Restricted data should not be accessed where screens or conversations can be observed.

FAQ: What if my internet fails?

Notify your manager, estimate the disruption and use an approved alternative if available. Do not move confidential work to an unapproved device or service to work around the issue.

Ownership

HR owns the policy with IT Security and Facilities as consulted stakeholders. The official repository contains the current version and approved location-specific addenda.